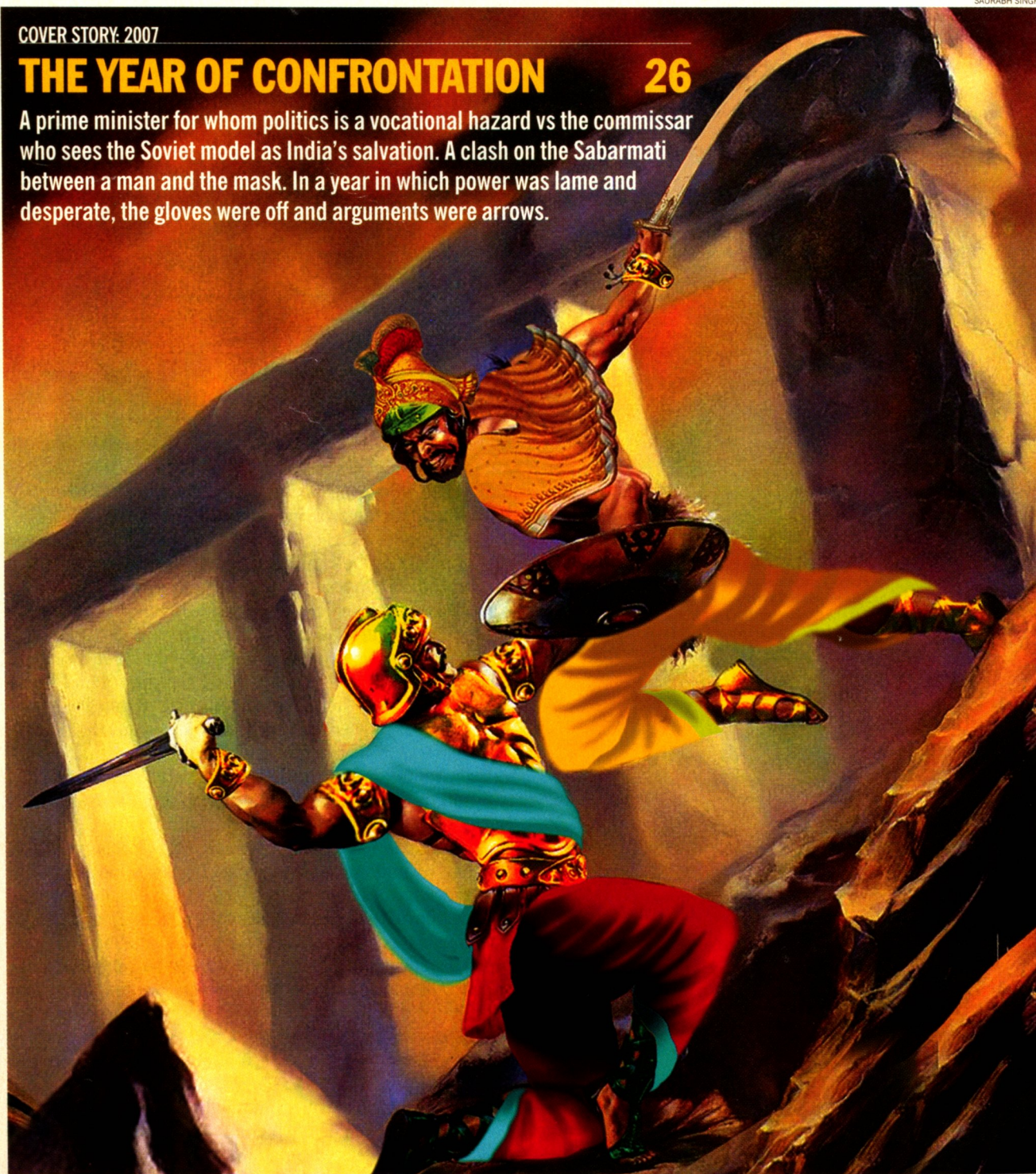


COVER STORY: 2007

THE YEAR OF CONFRONTATION 26

A prime minister for whom politics is a vocational hazard vs the commissar who sees the Soviet model as India's salvation. A clash on the Sabarmati between a man and the mask. In a year in which power was lame and desperate, the gloves were off and arguments were arrows.

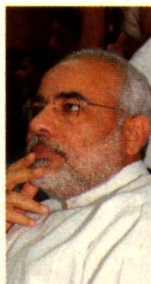


POLITICS

THE DEATH OF DIGNITY

30

Verbal pugilists from all parties are playing it dirty and personal. Skullduggery is in vogue and civility is on the wane.


SIPRA DAS

TIRTHUVVAN TIWARI

DIPLOMACY

THE NUCLEAR SHOWDOWN

38

A battle with the Left and Parliament over the nuke deal tests the art of blinkmanship and puts foreign policy in doldrums.

